Business Brain Quiz League

Season 3 · Game Week 7

Semifinals · QM: Team BBQL

Before we start

- 64 questions across 8 rounds, including one video round.
- The top 2 in each game move on to the tier finals.
- **Phones off. Eyes and hands on screen at all times.**
- Tie-breakers (spare questions) only if there is a tie for 2nd place.

Round 1

Players 1–4 · two questions each

1.

- More tycoons are leaping from boardroom to ballot box.
- A banana tycoon whose group controls the Bonita brand ran for president five times and lost every time, three of them in runoffs.
- His Miami-born son, Daniel Noboa, logistics director at the family export firm, won a 2023 snap election at 35 to become the youngest elected president in its history, and was re-elected in 2025.
- **Which country is this, the world's largest exporter of bananas?**

1.

ECUADOR

- Álvaro Noboa’s banana business made his family the richest in **Ecuador**, but voters rejected him in all five of his attempts to become president. His son, Daniel Noboa, won the 2023 snap election and was re-elected for a full term in 2025.
- **Ecuador**, followed by Guatemala, the Philippines, Colombia and Costa Rica, exports the most bananas in the world. The biggest producers, however, are India, China and Indonesia, which eat almost all of their own bananas: the four largest producers do not even appear among the top ten exporters, while Ecuador, only the fifth largest producer, leads the world with about 28% of global exports.

2.

- **Name's the same (almost):**
- One is a fictional FBI doctor whose influence on women entering science careers was given its own name in a 2018 study.
- The other left the top job at a cola maker in 1983 to run a computer firm and pushed out its co-founder.

2.

SCULLY/SCULLEY

- The “**Scully Effect**” study found that Dana Scully, the FBI doctor in The X-Files, encouraged many women to choose careers in science. John Sculley left Pepsi in 1983 to run Apple, and in 1985 he pushed co-founder Steve Jobs out of the company.

3.

- A few successful writers started off as copywriters!
- **Which Australian author** spent more than a decade in advertising as a copywriter before moving to writing novels, two of which became hit TV series starring Nicole Kidman: Big Little Lies and Nine Perfect Strangers?
- She shares her surname with a villain from crime fiction?

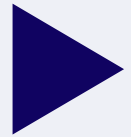
3.

Liane MORIARTY

- She worked in advertising for more than ten years before she started writing novels such as Big Little Lies and Nine Perfect Strangers. She shares her surname with Professor Moriarty, the villain in the Sherlock Holmes stories.

4.

- This 2025 ad parodies work culture and bosses.
- **What was it promoting?**



Video question: play the clip

4.

SHARK TANK 5 Entries (accept anything with Shark tank)

- The ad was Sony LIV’s registration campaign for Shark Tank India Season 5, and it made fun of hustle culture by telling viewers to keep making their bosses richer.

▶ **Watch on YouTube**

5.

- **Which brand** began in 1944 when a Miami pharmacist invented a suntan lotion sold with the slogan “Tan, don’t burn”?
- In the 1950s, the brand introduced a little-girl mascot whose swimsuit is tugged down by a puppy, revealing her tan line in a cheeky, risqué image for its time.
- In 2025, rugby star Ilona Maher recreated the iconic pose.



5.

COPPERTONE

- The name Coppertone describes the deep, copper-coloured tan that the lotion promised, which was the fashionable look Miami pharmacist Benjamin Green was selling when he created it in 1944. Coppertone is owned by Beiersdorf, the German company behind Nivea, which completed its purchase of the brand from Bayer for 550 million US dollars in September 2019.



6.

- In 1694, King William III needed money to fight France and the goldsmiths would not lend, so a Scottish merchant proposed a public loan.
- **Which institution**, still going today, was formed by the 1,268 people who lent 1.2 million pounds at 8% interest in just 11 days?

6.

BANK OF ENGLAND

- The Scottish merchant **William Paterson** proposed the plan, and the people who lent the money became the bank’s first shareholders. The loan helped King William III pay for his war against France. It is the world’s second-oldest central bank, after Sweden’s Riksbank, which was founded in 1668. Paterson later led the Darien scheme, a failed attempt to start a Scottish colony in Panama.

7.

- **Identify the common surname**: One is a waitress in a TV series that debuted in the 1990s, who becomes a buyer at Bloomingdale’s, then Ralph Lauren, and gets a Louis Vuitton offer in Paris.
- The other is a British retail tycoon who built the Arcadia Group, owner of Topshop and Dorothy Perkins, and who sold BHS for £1 in 2015, a year before it collapsed with a £571m pension deficit, sealing his fall from glory.

7.

GREEN

- Rachel Green of Friends starts as a waitress and later builds a career as a fashion buyer. Sir Philip Green built the Arcadia retail group and was widely criticised after BHS collapsed with a large pension deficit.

8.

- Billionaire Bidzina Ivanishvili began by selling computers and phones in post-Soviet Russia, then co-founded a Russian bank and profited from privatised metals.
- Back home he founded a party that won the 2012 election, served barely a year as prime minister, and now holds a post created for him as its honorary chairman, granting him the right to name the PM.
- **Which country is this?**

8.

GEORGIA

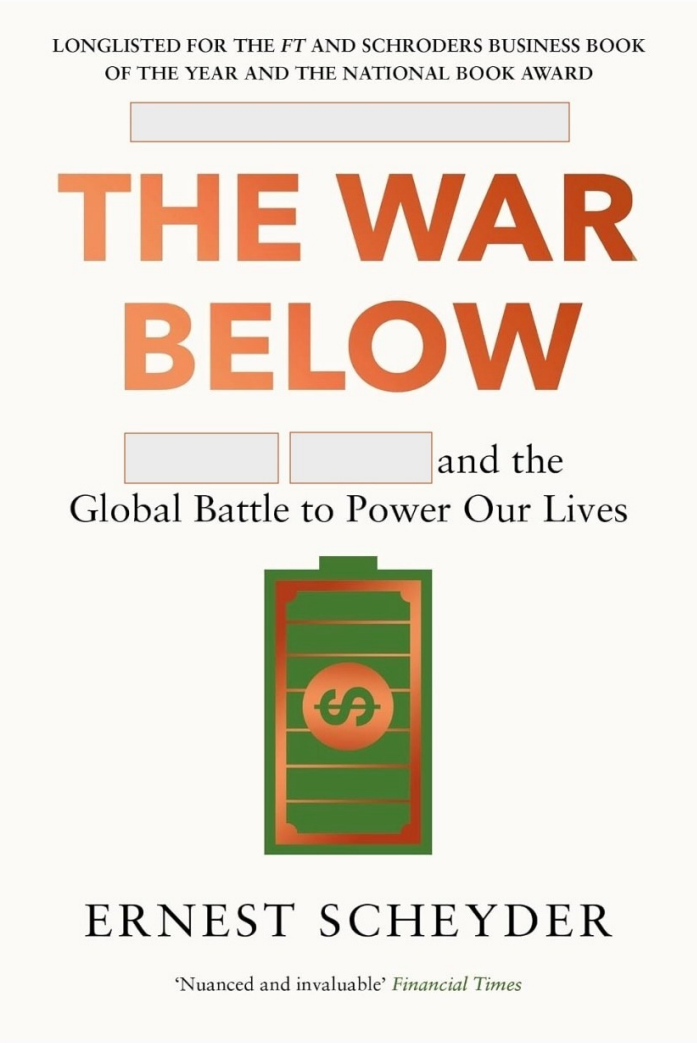
- Bidzina Ivanishvili founded the Georgian Dream party, which won the 2012 election. Even without holding a government post, he is widely seen as the most powerful person in the country.

Round 2

Players 1–4 · two questions each

9.

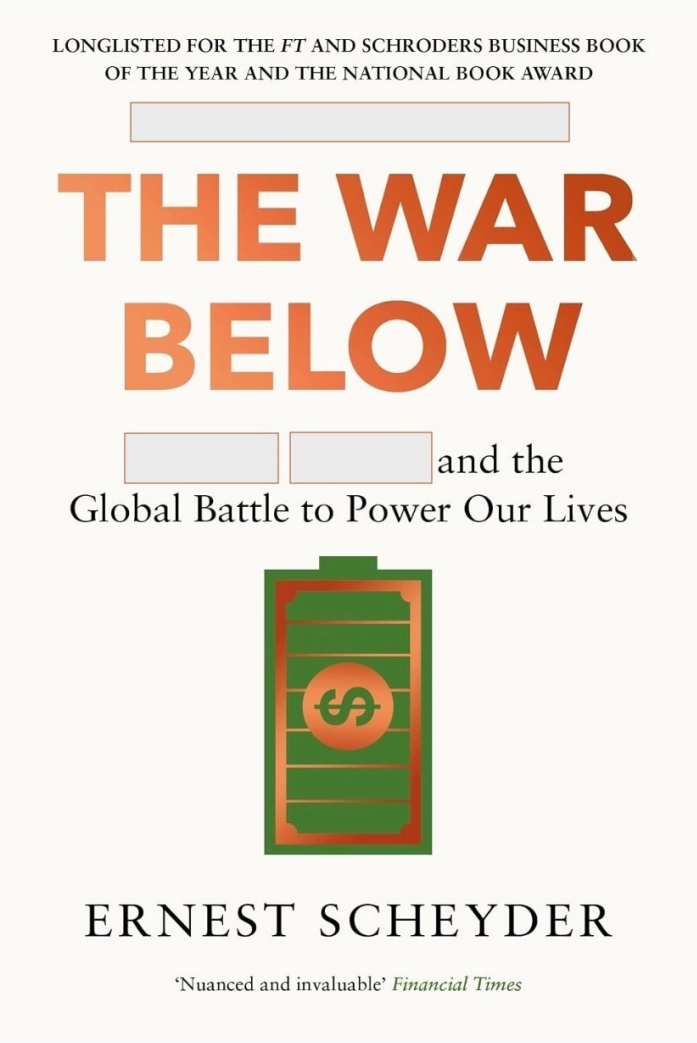
- Business bestsellers, FT prize winners among them, now promise war and doom.
- Reuters energy correspondent Ernest Scheyder's 2024 book The War Below is about the fight over mining the metals needed for clean energy.
- Its subtitle names two metals: Chile is the world's largest miner of one and the second largest of the other.
- One powers electric car batteries, the other carries electricity through wires.
- **Name both blanks in the subtitle**



9.

LITHIUM COPPER

- Lithium is used in electric car batteries, and copper is used in electrical wiring. Chile is the world's largest producer of copper and one of the largest producers of lithium. The focus of the book is entirely US though!



10.

- Introduced in 1914, this girl with an umbrella in the rain comes with the slogan “When it rains, it pours.”
- **Name the brand.**



10.

MORTON Salt

- The slogan meant that Morton salt kept pouring easily even in wet weather. This was possible because, in 1911, the company began adding magnesium carbonate, which absorbs moisture and stops the salt from forming lumps. Today, Morton uses calcium silicate for the same purpose.



11.

- **Nickname’s the same**:
- One is the tightly controlled chief of staff to business titan Mike Prince in the hedge fund drama Billions.
- The other found a 13-year-old Justin Bieber on YouTube in 2008, then bought the masters of a pop star’s first six albums, sparking a bitter feud in which she re-recorded them to undercut their value.
- He has lately been dating actress Sydney Sweeney.

11.

SCOOTER

- “Scooter” is the nickname of Mike Prince’s chief of staff in Billions. Scooter Braun discovered Justin Bieber and later bought the masters of Taylor Swift’s first six albums, which led her to re-record them.

12.

- **Name the country**: A Forbes-listed billionaire Petro Poroshenko who started out supplying cocoa beans to the Soviet chocolate industry built a confectionery group named after the middle letters of his surname, and also owned a shipyard and a TV channel.
- Months after a revolution he won the presidency in 2014, then lost it in 2019 to a comedian who had played a president on TV.

12.

UKRAINE

- Petro Poroshenko named his chocolate company Roshen, using the middle letters of his surname. He lost the 2019 election to Volodymyr Zelensky, who had played a president in the TV series Servant of the People.

13.

- First recorded as British slang for a pound in the 1680s, this one-syllable word probably comes from a Latin word meaning what or something.
- It is also the first part of a famous Latin phrase about exchange.
- **Name this word**, which remains everyday British slang for the pound.

13.

QUID

- In Latin, “quid” means “what” or “something.” The phrase “quid pro quo” means “something for something,” which is why the question refers to exchange.

14.

- This American author rose from junior copywriter to creative director at the ad agency J. Walter Thompson, where in 1982 he co-created a toy store jingle with the line ‘I don’t wanna grow up’.
- **Name this writer**, one of the world’s best-selling novelists, later created detective Alex Cross and co-wrote thrillers with Bill Clinton and Dolly Parton?

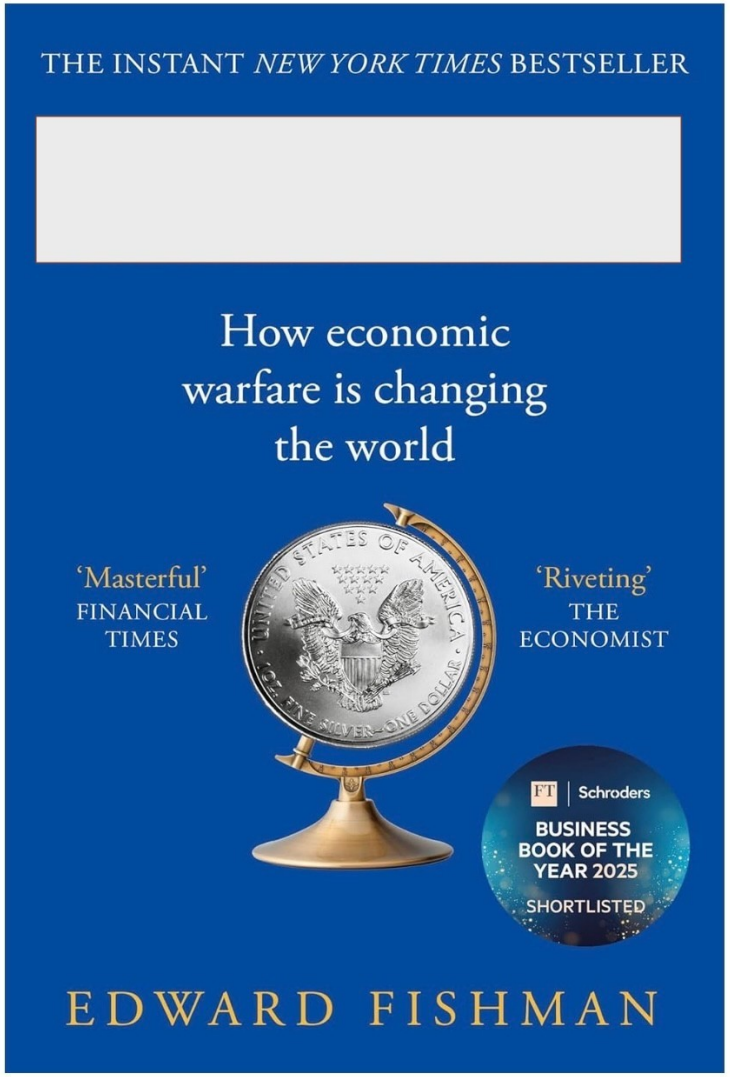
14.

James PATTERSON

- While working in advertising, he co-created the Toys R Us jingle with the line “I don’t wanna grow up.” He later became one of the world’s best-selling novelists and wrote books with Bill Clinton and Dolly Parton.

15.

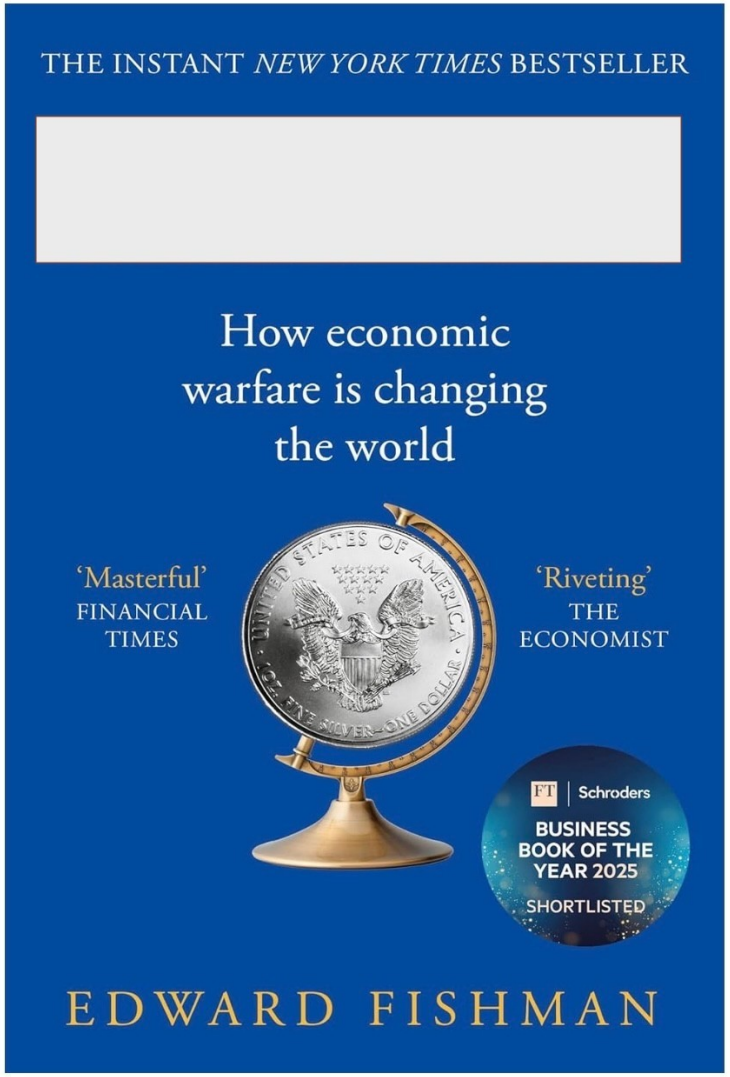
- Edward Fishman helped design Western sanctions on Russia after Crimea and the pressure campaign behind the 2015 Iran nuclear deal.
- **What military term** did he borrow for the title of his 2025 book, subtitled How Economic Warfare Is Changing the World, which argues that control of a few critical nodes in global finance and technology lets a superpower cut rivals off?



15.

CHOKEPOINTS

- In military language, a chokepoint is a narrow passage that a small force can control. Fishman uses the term to describe how control of key parts of finance and technology lets a powerful country cut off its rivals.



16.

- In 1989, New York real estate developer Seymour Durst put up a large electronic clock near Times Square.
- It was switched off between 2000 and 2002 because its number was falling.
- On 30 September 2008 it ran out of digits, and its dollar sign was turned into a ‘1′.
- **What does it display?**

16.

US NATIONAL DEBT Clock

- The clock was switched off for a while because the debt was going down. In 2008, the debt passed $10 trillion, and the clock did not have enough digits to display the new number. In August 2026, t**he debt passed $40 trillion** for the first time, reaching $40.05 trillion according to Treasury data, only five months after it hit $39 trillion in March.

Round 3

Players 1–4 · two questions each

17.

- In the Book of Leviticus, every 50th year was announced with a blast on a ram’s horn.
- Land went back to its original families, and people sold into bondage for debt went free.
- **What is it called, a widely used English word?**
- A 1990s campaign backed by Bono and Pope John Paul II to cancel poor countries’ debts by the year 2000 took its name.

JUBILEE

- The word Jubilee comes from the Hebrew yovel, the ram’s horn blown to announce the year. The Jubilee 2000 campaign drew on this idea of releasing debts to push for the cancellation of poor countries’ debts in time for the millennium.

18.

- **Name both**: Canada’s 1987 dollar coin was meant to show a canoeing voyageur, but the minting dies went missing, so a waterbird went on it and gave the coin its nickname.
- Its 1996 two-dollar partner shows a polar bear, but its nickname simply blends the number two with the first coin’s.

18.

LOONIE and TOONIE

- The one-dollar coin shows a common loon, so Canadians began calling it the “loonie.” When the two-dollar coin arrived, people combined “two” and “loonie” to create the name “toonie.” The two dollar coin shows a polar bear.

19.

- This charcoal sketch of a neighbour’s baby won a 1928 company contest and became a trademark in 1931.
- The baby grew up to be an English teacher and mystery novelist.
- **Name the brand,** now owned by Nestle.



19.

GERBER

- The artist Dorothy Hope Smith drew a sketch of her neighbour’s baby, Ann Turner Cook, who later became an English teacher and a mystery writer. Nestlé bought the Gerber brand in 2007.



20.

- On 3 October 2010, the 20th anniversary of its reunification, Germany made its final payment on **what debt,** once fixed at 132 billion gold marks, which a 1953 agreement in London had partly cancelled while putting off some of the interest until the country was united again?

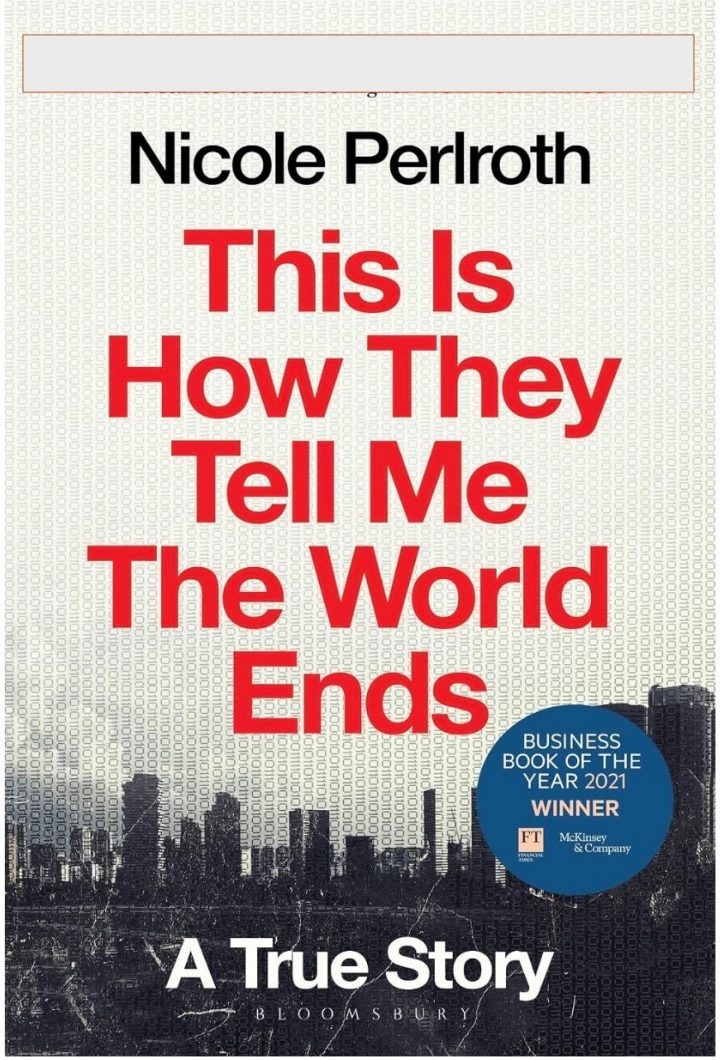
20.

WW I Reparations or accept TREATY OF VERSAILLES

- **WWI reparations (Treaty of Versailles).** The 1953 London agreement put off some of Germany's interest payments until the country was reunited. Germany made the final payment on 3 October 2010, exactly 20 years after reunification.

21.

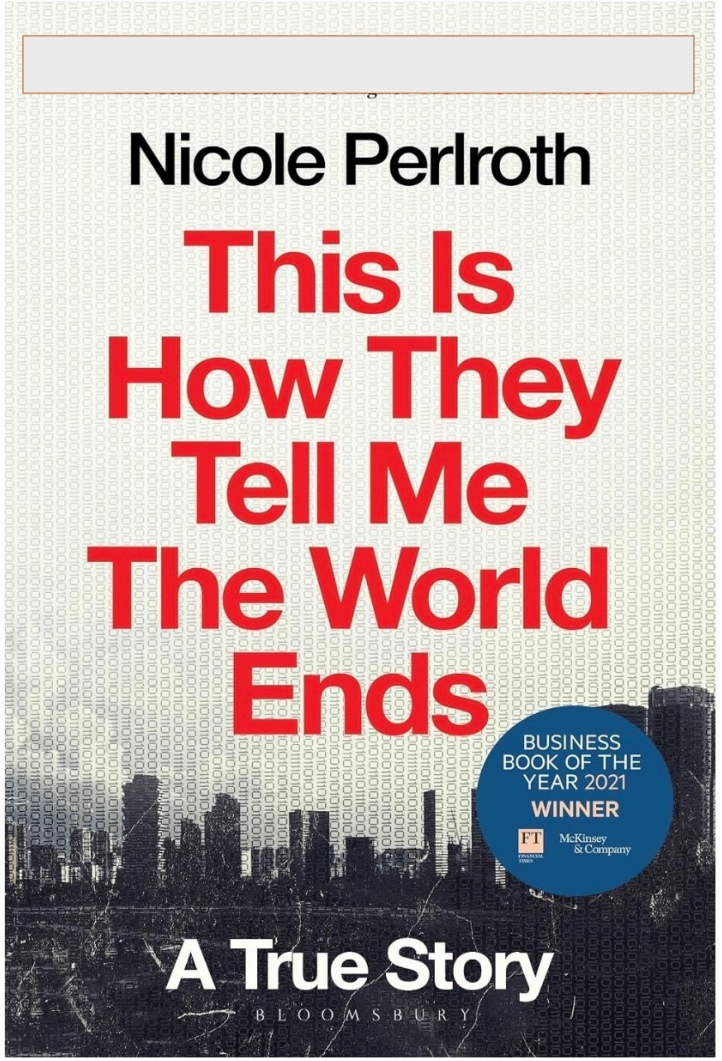
- Nicole Perlroth's book, winner of the 2021 FT Business Book of the Year, is titled This Is How They Tell Me the World Ends.
- **What is the subject** of the book?



21.

CYBERWEAPONS/CYBERWARFARE between states

- **Cyberweapons / cyberwarfare.** The book's subtitle is "The Cyberweapons Arms Race." It explains how governments buy hidden software flaws and use them as weapons against other countries.



22.

- **Surname's the Same:**
- One is a fictional 1960s creative director, born Dick Whitman, who took a dead officer’s name in Korea.
- The other backed Hotmail and Skype and hosts a show where startups pitch for a $1 million investment.

22.

DRAPER

- Don Draper is the creative director in Mad Men who took another man’s identity during the Korean War. Tim Draper is a venture capitalist who backed Hotmail and Skype and hosts the startup pitch show Meet the Drapers.

23.

- This poet spent about 12 years in New York in magazine marketing, including at Condé Nast for titles such as GQ and Travel + Leisure.
- She later became the 24th US Poet Laureate (2022–2025) and the first Latina in the role, and her collection The Carrying won the National Book Critics Circle Award.
- **Name her.**

23.

Ada LIMON

- She worked in magazine marketing in New York for about 12 years before becoming a full-time poet. She later became the 24th US Poet Laureate and the first Latina to hold the position.

24.

- Launched in Japan in 1975 by an American soft drink giant, this canned coffee sells mainly through vending machines and is a top selling ready to drink coffee.
- Its name comes from the parent company’s home base.
- **Name the brand.**

GEORGIA

- **Georgia (coffee).** Coca-Cola has its headquarters in Atlanta, Georgia. The company named its Japanese canned coffee brand after its home state.

Round 4

Players 1–4 · two questions each

25.

- For Diwali 2024, **which Indian brand** ran a viral campaign to restore the image of a festive staple that had become a national meme?
- The item was famous as the unwanted Diwali gift that everyone received but nobody kept, passed endlessly from one household to the next.
- **Alternately give us the full ad line,** inspired by a famous American campaign line..



Video question: play the clip

25.

ZEPTO; Make Soan Papdi Great Again

- Soan papdi had become a running joke as the Diwali gift that people received and then passed on to someone else. Zepto’s campaign line is a play on Donald Trump’s slogan. Watch the full promo ad.

▶ **Watch on YouTube**

26.

- **Which Australian novelist**, who won the Booker Prize twice, for Oscar and Lucinda in 1988 and True History of the Kelly Gang in 2001, had earlier written ads for Volkswagen and Lindeman’s Wine in Melbourne, worked for Grey Advertising in Sydney and in 1980 co-founded an agency that carried his surname?

26.

Peter CAREY

- He worked in advertising for many years and co-founded his own agency in 1980. He later became one of the few writers to win the Booker Prize twice.

27.

- This plural slang for a big-denomination US banknote comes from the founding father whose face is printed on it.
- It fills the blank in the title of a 1997 Puff Daddy hit, It’s All About the BLANK.
- Around 80% of these notes are reckoned to be held outside the US.
- **What is the slang?**

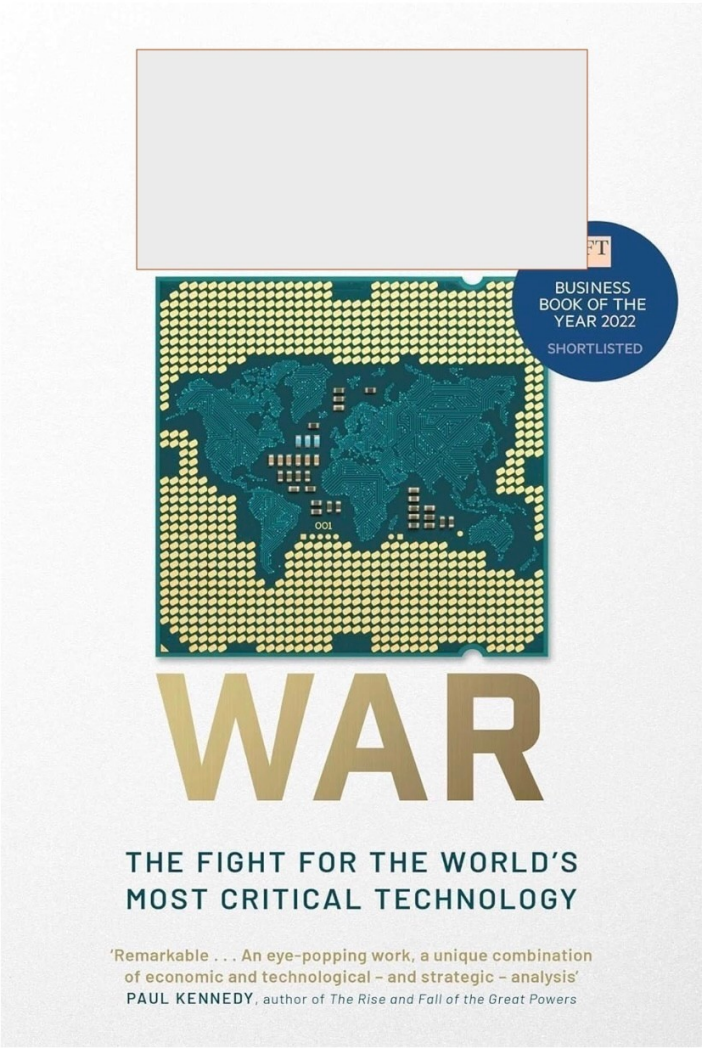
27.

BENJAMINS

- Benjamin Franklin’s portrait appears on the US $100 bill, so “Benjamins” became slang for large amounts of money. Most $100 bills are held outside the United States, where people keep them as a safe store of value.
- The song (It's All About the Benjamins")’s artist, Puff Daddy (Sean Combs), was convicted in 2025 on two federal prostitution-related charges and sentenced to 50 months in prison, although he was acquitted of the more serious sex trafficking and racketeering charges.

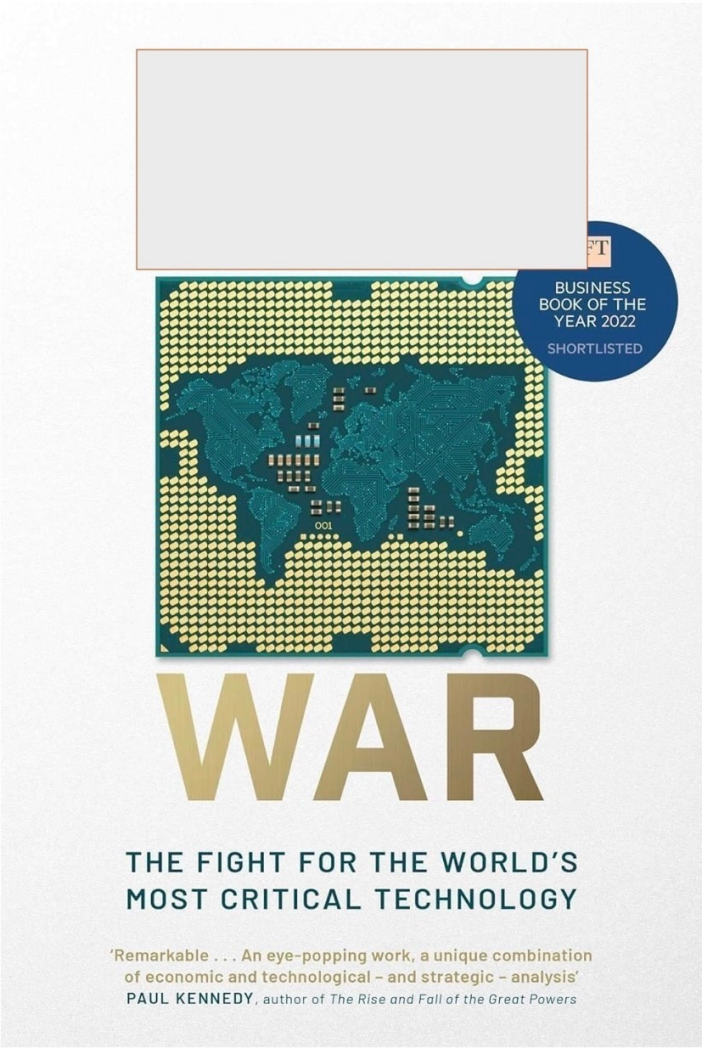
28.

- Tufts historian Chris Miller's book won the 2022 FT Business Book of the Year.
- It describes a contest between the US and China for control of what the subtitle calls the world's most critical technology.
- **What is the first word of the title?**



28.

CHIP


FT
BUSINESS BOOK OF THE YEAR 2022
SHORTLISTED
WAR
THE FIGHT FOR THE WORLD'S MOST CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY
'Remarkable . . . An eye-popping work, a unique combination of economic and technological – and strategic – analysis'
PAUL KENNEDY, author of The Rise and Fall of the Great Powers

29.

- **Name the country**: A billionaire chemicals trader, Andrej Babis took over the Agrofert group in 1993 and built it into a farming, food and chemicals empire.
- He founded a party whose name means yes in the local language, served as prime minister from 2017 to 2021, has faced a long-running EU subsidy fraud case, and won back the top job in 2025.

CZECH REPUBLIC

- Andrej Babiš’s party is called ANO, which means “yes” in Czech. He became prime minister again after his party won the 2025 election.

30.

- In this 2026 ad, filmmaker Zoya Akhtar tries again and again to shoot the perfect action scene, but the shot never goes the way she wants.
- **Which brand made this ad?**



Video question: play the clip

30.

CEAT Tyres

- In the ad, Zoya Akhtar keeps trying to film a car skidding, but every take fails. She finally checks the car and finds that it has CEAT tyres, whose strong grip stops it from skidding.

▶ **Watch on YouTube**

31.

- This sound effect imitates the bell on a cash register.
- A Dayton saloon owner who suspected his bartenders of stealing patented the machine in 1879, and pressing its total key opened the drawer and rang the bell.
- In 2003, Shania Twain used the word as the title of a hit mocking greed, which opens with the sound of a till.
- **What is this compound word** used as slang in the context of money?

KA-CHING

- James Ritty, a saloon owner in Dayton, invented the cash register to stop his bartenders from stealing. The bell that rang when the drawer opened is the origin of “ka-ching,” which is now slang for making money.

32.

- Lorraine Collett was one of the girls handing out samples for a California growers' group at a 1915 San Francisco fair.
- Her red bonnet and tray of grapes became its logo.
- **Name the brand.**



32.

SUN MAID Girl

- Lorraine Collett was photographed in her red bonnet holding a tray of grapes. That picture became the logo of the Sun-Maid raisin brand.



Round 5

Players 1–4 · two questions each

33.

- CNBC India has been a talent pipeline for journalists.
- She worked at Dow Jones and The Economic Times before joining CNBC-TV18 as chief of its news bureau.
- As banking editor and, from 2008, executive editor, she became the channel’s go-to voice on banks, money markets and the economy, and anchored its markets show Bazaar.
- **Name her.**



33.

Latha VENKATESH



34.

- During the coffee wars of 2008, local franchisees of this fast-food giant put up a billboard near Starbucks headquarters that read “Four bucks is dumb,” mocking the price of a Starbucks drink.
- Corporate had not approved it, and it was taken down.
- The chain has kept pushing hard into coffee ever since, and its cafe sub-brand is now the largest coffee chain in Australia, with over 1,000 outlets.
- **Which fast-food chain is this?**

34.

MCDONALDS or MCCAFE

35.

- Created in 1966 at Havana’s secret El Laguito factory for Fidel Castro and foreign diplomats, this prestigious Cuban cigar brand went on sale commercially in 1982.
- Its name derives from a Taíno word for the tobacco rolls encountered by Christopher Columbus.
- Famous for its Behike and Siglo series, **what is this brand?**

35.

COHIBA

- The cigar was first made only for Fidel Castro and as a gift for foreign diplomats. Its name comes from the Taíno word for the rolled tobacco leaves that Christopher Columbus saw.

36.

- This payment system is used in **which country?**
- The 4 colours used in the QR are inspired by the country's flag.



36.

SRI LANKA

- The payment system shown is LankaQR, and its colours come from the Sri Lankan flag. The flag’s colours are maroon, gold, green and saffron, so “maroon” is more accurate than “red.”



37.

- Established in 1953 by British colonial administrators—six years before the production of the massive Burgan oil field transformed the Persian Gulf, the [BLANK] Investment Authority manages the General Reserve Fund and the Future Generations Fund.
- Designed to preserve capital for a post-petroleum era, **What Gulf state** holds the title of operating the world's oldest sovereign wealth fund?

37.

KUWAIT

- The Kuwait Investment Board, set up in 1953, is considered the world’s first sovereign wealth fund.

38.

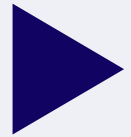
- Singles’ Day began in 1993 as a joke among four single students at Nanjing University.
- In 2009 Alibaba turned it into a 24-hour online shopping festival, and by 2021 its sales alone topped $84 billion.
- **On what appropriate date** of the year is it held?

38.

11 Nov (11/11)

39.

- In this ad from India’s largest carmaker, **what iconic 3-word question** does the scuba diver ask at the end?
- (English translation not acceptable)



Video question: play the clip

39.

KITNA DETI HAI

- Don't accept anything else like what is the mileage etc. Language variants are fine like Evvalavu Tharum (Tamil), Koto Dey (Bengali)

40.

- After Thomson Reuters, she joined CNBC-TV18 in 2008 as deputy head of research and became one of its best-known market anchors.
- She left in September 2024 after 16 years and, within weeks, relaunched herself as a financial content creator signed by a talent agency.
- **Name her.**



40.

Sonia SHENOY



Round 6

Players 1–4 · two questions each

41.

- This conglomerate has its business spread across diverse sectors, from business services to infrastructure, from metals to energy division to machinery etc.
- It is also one of the dominant players in the global tuna trade controlling more than one-third of the Bluefin Tuna market.
- **Which group?**

41.

MITSUBISHI

42.

- Valued at over $2.2 trillion, the Government Pension Fund Global owns roughly 1.5% of all publicly traded shares worldwide.
- Governed by a strict "fiscal rule" and advised by an independent Ethics Council, **What Nordic nation** operates this massive sovereign fund?

NORWAY

43.

- This drive thru coffee chain began in 1992 as a pushcart in Grants Pass, Oregon, started by brothers Dane and Travis Boersma.
- It is now one of the fastest-growing coffee chains in the US.
- **What famous symbol** of the country the brothers' ancestors came from appears on its cups?

43.

WINDMILL; Dutch Bros

- The Boersma brothers have Dutch ancestors, so they named the business Dutch Bros. The windmill on the cups is one of the best-known symbols of the Netherlands. Dutch Bros had 1,225 shops across 26 states as of 30 June 2026, its latest official count. It opened 41 shops in the first quarter and 48 in the second, and it plans to open at least 185 in 2026. By state, a store-tracking count from September 2026 put California first with 253 locations, followed by Texas with 230 and Oregon, its home state, with 157.



44.

- She joined the channel now known as CNBC-TV18 in 2000 and became its managing editor in 2013.
- She has long anchored one of India’s longest-running shows on entrepreneurs, Young Turks, and was named a WEF Young Global Leader in 2009.
- **Name her.**



44.

Shereen BHAN



45.

- In 1895 a Basel merchant married Adèle and, following Swiss custom, added her surname to his own.
- In 1896 he founded a drug firm under the combined name, now known worldwide by her name alone.
- Its chemist Leo Sternbach invented Valium, America’s most prescribed drug from 1969 to 1982.
- **Name the firm: two surnames, hyphenated.**

45.

HOFFMANN-LA ROCHE

- Fritz Hoffmann followed Swiss custom by adding his wife Adèle La Roche’s surname to his own. The company’s legal name is still F. Hoffmann-La Roche, but it is known around the world simply as Roche.

46.

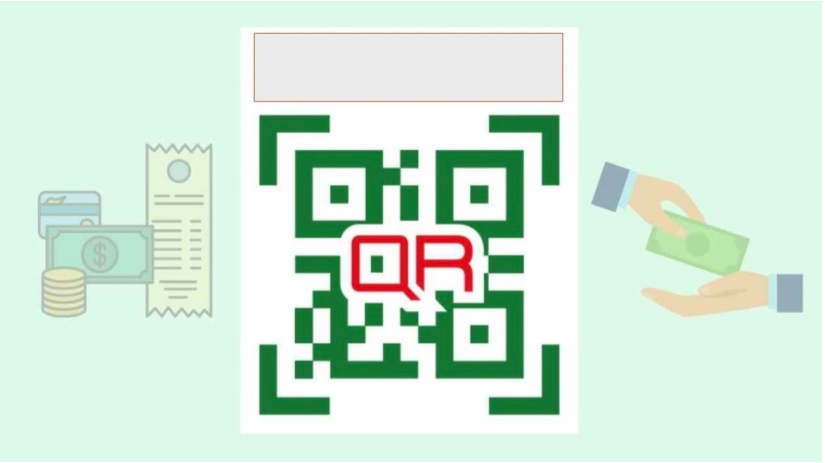
- Dubbed the “$1,000 Cigar,” the ultra-exclusive His Majesty’s Reserve features a 15-year-old Connecticut broadleaf wrapper infused with Louis XIII Cognac.
- **What luxury cigar maker**, led by Kaizad Hansotia, takes its name from Nepalese soldiers and is famed for lavish limited-edition packaging?

46.

GURKHA Cigars

47.

- This payment system is used in **which Asian country?**
- The colours are inspired by the country's flag - dark green and red.



47.

BANGLADESH

- The Bangladesh flag



48.

- The UN marks International Equal Pay Day on 18 September.
- The US and UK set their own Equal Pay Days, which can shift from year to year, but the reason behind the date is similar.
- Why does the UN mark it on 18 September?
- (may need an explanation here)

48.

By 18 September, men have already earned what women will take the rest of the year to earn.

- **After 18 September, women are in effect working for free.** Because women earn less than men on average, it is as if they work the rest of the year without pay. The US and UK calculate their dates from the size of their own national pay gaps, while the UN uses a fixed date to make the same point.

Round 7

Players 1–4 · two questions each

49.

- In cybersecurity, **what term** describes a software flaw that the maker does not yet know about, so it has had no time at all to fix it.
- Hackers can sell such flaws for over $1 million, and the US and Israel used several to sabotage Iran’s nuclear centrifuges.

DAY ZERO

- The usual term is “zero-day,” because the software maker has had zero days to fix the flaw. The Stuxnet attack used several zero-day flaws to damage the centrifuges in Iran’s nuclear programme.

50.

- Its 1931 Reverso watch was made to protect the watch glass: its case flips over so polo players in British India stopped cracking it.
- Queen Elizabeth II wore its Calibre 101, long called the world’s smallest mechanical movement, at her 1953 coronation, a gift from the French president.
- **Name this Swiss maker, two surnames hyphenated.**

50.

JAEGER-LECOULTRE

51.

- In the 1970s and 1980s, the Phosphate Royalties Trust built a sprawling real estate empire that included the 52-story [BLANK] House skyscraper in Melbourne.
- However, reckless borrowing, failed investments, and the total exhaustion of its central island's mineral deposits rendered the fund bankrupt by the early 2000s.
- **Which Pacific island nation** created this tragic, fallen sovereign wealth fund?

NAURU

- Nauru became rich from phosphate mining and invested the money in property such as Nauru House in Melbourne. Poor investments, heavy borrowing and the end of the phosphate supply left the fund almost empty.

52.

- In his 1997 letter to shareholders, Jeff Bezos said it was "BLANK BLANK" for the internet and for his company.
- He reprinted that letter every year, signed off later ones with “Our approach remains the same, because it’s still BLANK BLANK” and “It remains BLANK BLANK”, and even named his office building after it.
- **Fill in the two short blanks**

DAY ONE

- Bezos used “Day 1” to mean that Amazon should always act like a hungry new startup. He warned that “Day 2” would mean the start of decline, and he named Amazon’s Day 1 tower in Seattle after the idea.

53.

- In the 1960s, this company extended the product line of one of its famous brands.
- They named the product line X Kitchen Entrees, X being both the above mentioned brand as well as part of the company name.
- The 2 varieties of entrees were made from dried chicken and crab meat respectively.
- However, the customers did not like the new products and these had to be scrapped soon.
- **Which brand?**

53.

COLGATE

54.

- Founded in 2017, this Chinese coffee chain admitted in 2020 to faking over 300 million dollars in sales and was delisted from Nasdaq.
- It later recovered and overtook Starbucks in China by store count and revenue.
- **Name the chain.**

54.

LUCKIN

55.

- Founded in Havana in 1935 by Alonso Menéndez, this Cuban cigar brand took its name from a classic 1844 adventure novel famously read aloud to factory rollers.
- Its distinctive logo features six swords surrounding a fleur-de-lis.
- **What is the brand?**

55.

MONTECRISTO

- The brand is named after Alexandre Dumas’s novel The Count of Monte Cristo, which readers in cigar factories often read aloud to the workers. The swords in the logo reflect the adventure story.

56.

- This brand, well - known in its own sector, also produces honey under the brand name 'Turbienchen' which literally means 'tiny turbo bee' as part of its corporate conservation and biodiversity projects.
- Currently, close to 3 million bees have their colony around the company's Leipzig plant.
- **Which brand?**

56.

PORSCHE

- Turbienchen" combines “Turbo,” the name of Porsche’s famous models, with “Bienchen,” the German word for “little bee.” The bees live on the grounds of Porsche’s factory in Leipzig.

Round 8

Players 1–4 · two questions each

57.

- **This payment system is used in which country?**
- The word Duit means 'money' in the informal local language.



57.

MALAYSIA



58.

- Founded in Kiev in 1911 by Ukrainian-born tobacconist Zino, this luxury cigar house later moved to Geneva and established a major presence in the Dominican Republic’s Yaque Valley.
- Known for its elegant White Label and bolder black-label cigars, **what brand bears its founder’s name?**

58.

DAVIDOFF

- Zino Davidoff turned his family’s tobacco shop into a global luxury cigar brand. Note: most accounts say his father, Henri, opened the shop in Geneva in 1911 after leaving Kiev, when Zino was still a young boy.

59.

- R.J. Reynolds named two cigarette brands after the two halves of its home city, which merged in 1913.
- The first part was America’s top-selling cigarette until Marlboro overtook it in the 1970s.
- The second part, the first filter menthol, is named for the city, Moravians founded in 1766, after the Hebrew word for peace.
- **Name the city: two names hyphenated.**

59.

WINSTON-SALEM

- R.J. Reynolds named its Winston and Salem cigarettes after the two towns that joined to form the city. The name Salem comes from the Hebrew word “shalom,” which means peace.

60.

- This company once launched a range of fragrances in association with L'Oreal between 1994 and 2005.
- Some names include 'Destiny Man', 'Destiny Woman', 'Territory', 'Hot Road', 'Black Fire', among others.
- **Which company?**

60.

HARLEY DAVIDSON

61.

- After more than 19 years at CNBC-TV18, where she rose to executive editor and created a TV show on law and policy, she became managing editor of BloombergQuint in 2016.
- She left in 2022 and is now a senior editor at Bloomberg India.
- **Name her.**



61.

Menaka DOSHI



62.

- **This payment system is used in which country?**



CAMBODIA



63.

- Founded in Santiago de Cuba in 1862, this rum family took its bat logo from fruit bats in the distillery rafters, an idea of the founder’s wife.
- In 1993 it bought an Italian vermouth house founded in Turin in 1863.
- Its US arm was then renamed to carry both brand names.
- **What was that combined name, the two brands hyphenated?**

BACARDI-MARTINI

- Bacardi bought the Italian vermouth company Martini & Rossi in 1993 and combined the two names for its US business. The bat logo is still Bacardi’s best-known symbol.

64.

- The Public Investment Fund has reshaped global finance, sports, and entertainment by backing LIV Golf, acquiring Newcastle United FC, and anchor-funding SoftBank's $100 billion Vision Fund.
- **In which Middle Eastern nation** is this transformational $900 billion fund headquartered?

64.

SAUDI ARABIA

Spare Questions

Tie-breakers, only for a tie for 2nd place

S1.

- **What name, also the name of a bird**, is shared by a personal care brand from Unilever and a chocolate & ice brand owned by Mars?
- Interestingly, the 'soap' from this Unilever brand is not legally classified or labeled as 'soap' in USA because it does not meet the FDA's definition of traditional soap; instead, it is a beauty bar

S1.

DOVE

S2.

- One of the four ‘Queens of Crime’ of the Golden Age worked as a copywriter at S.H. Benson’s London agency from 1922 to 1931, where she wrote a Guinness jingle around the line ‘Guinness is good for you’.
- **Name this writer** who created detective Lord Peter Wimsey and later set her novel Murder Must Advertise in an ad agency?

S2.

Dorothy SAYERS

S3.

- Formed in 1974 following a constitutional amendment, the [BLANK] Permanent Fund invests state oil revenues to generate investment earnings for future generations.
- It is famously recognized for its Permanent Fund Dividend (PFD) program, which distributes annual royalty dividend checks directly to every eligible resident citizen.
- **What U.S. state**—treated here as the sovereign domain behind this fund—pioneered this direct-payout model?

ALASKA

S4.

- Founded in 1902 as a Minneapolis linseed oil crusher, this firm took its three-part name in 1923 after buying a rival.
- In the 1990s, executive Mark Whitacre wore an FBI wire to expose its lysine price-fixing, a story Matt Damon played in The Informant!
- **Name it.**

S4.

ARCHER-DANIELS-MIDLAND